CLYVARA / FILE — 2026 · DALLAS–FORT WORTH

S H I E L D

The SHIELD Framework

How small and mid-sized businesses build a complete cybersecurity programme — a practical guide to Clyvara's six-phase methodology.

WHAT SHIELD IS

A programme, not a product.

Most small businesses don't have a cybersecurity problem because they lack tools. They have one because they lack a programme — a defined sequence of what to do, in what order, with a way to prove it's working.

Clyvara exists because SMB cybersecurity failures are rarely a technology problem — they're a training and governance problem. That conclusion comes from original doctoral research into why small and mid-sized enterprise security programs actually fail, not a repackaged vendor checklist.

43%

of cyberattacks specifically target small and mid-sized businesses

SOURCE: ACCENTURE

95%

of data breaches involve human error — a training and governance failure, not a technology one

SOURCE: IBM

$200K+

is the average cost of a breach for a small or mid-sized business

SOURCE: HISCOX

Three problems sit underneath every engagement Clyvara takes on:

01 **SMBs are the primary target and the least protected.**
Most operate without a cybersecurity strategy, a trained workforce, or governance — while facing a disproportionate share of attacks.

02 **The root cause is human behavior, not missing technology.**
SMBs rarely lack security tools. They lack a security culture, a strategy that makes the tools work, and governance that holds the programme accountable.

03 **There's no affordable, credible advisory option between the two extremes.**
Enterprise security firms carry six-figure minimums. Generic IT consultants and awareness platforms deliver content and monitoring, not a programme.

> SHIELD is Clyvara's answer: a six-phase methodology, mapped to NIST CSF 2.0 and CIS Controls v8, that takes a business from unknown exposure to a managed, monitored security posture — each phase with a defined outcome and a deliverable you keep.

THE SHIELD MODEL

Six phases. One sequence.

Every engagement moves through the same six phases, in the same order. Nothing is skipped, and nothing is sold out of sequence.



S Survey *Start here*

A full risk assessment against your actual environment — not a generic checklist. You receive a prioritized, RAG-rated risk register. Every engagement begins here.

H Harden

Remediation of the highest-priority findings first — technical controls, access management, and configuration fixes sequenced by actual risk reduction.

I Instruct

Security awareness training built on the same research foundation behind Clyvara's methodology — addressing the human-error root cause directly, not a once-a-year video.

E Enforce

Incident response planning — a documented plan, defined roles, and a practiced response, so the business knows exactly what to do when something happens, not just when it should have.

L Ledger

A monthly one-page dashboard that keeps your risk register current between formal reviews, so issues get caught in weeks, not discovered during a breach or an audit.

D Defend

The SHIELD Defend Retainer — fractional CISO access and incident-readiness support for businesses that want a standing partner, not a one-time project.

INSIDE EACH PHASE

What each phase runs on, and what you keep.

Each phase is grounded in a named framework — not an internal opinion about best practice — and ends with a deliverable that belongs to you, not to Clyvara.

PHASE	FRAMEWORK BASIS	WHAT YOU WALK AWAY WITH
S — Survey	NIST CSF 2.0 (Govern + Identify)	A RAG-rated Risk Register and a plain-English Risk Summary, mapping digital assets, access points, data flows, and human behaviors.
H — Harden	CIS Controls v8 (Implementation Group 1)	A practical Cybersecurity Policy, access control guidelines, a remote work policy, and a CIS IG1 gap report — sized for a team without a dedicated security function.
I — Instruct	NIST SP 800-50 + Clyvara's DBA research	A three-module behavior-change training programme customized to actual workflows, with a phishing simulation baseline and a post-training comparison.
E — Enforce	Governance & Incident Readiness	An Incident Response Plan, a tabletop exercise, a vendor risk checklist, and regulatory mapping (HIPAA, PCI-DSS, CMMC, and applicable state privacy obligations).
L — Ledger	Ongoing Metrics & Reporting	A monthly one-page dashboard — risk score trend, training completion, phishing results, incidents logged — plus an Insurance Readiness Summary for renewals.
D — Defend	Fractional CISO Retainer	A monthly advisory session, policy updates, quarterly refresher training, a priority incident advisory line, and an annual security programme review.

WHERE INSTRUCT COMES FROM

Instruct is the one phase built specifically on original research rather than a published standard alone. It's grounded in doctoral research into what actually changes security behavior in small and mid-sized businesses — which is also why it's the phase most often misunderstood. See "Where Organizations Get Stuck," page 8.

EXECUTIVE SHIELD CHECK

Five questions worth asking before the SHIELD Risk Conversation.

This isn't a scored assessment — there's no number at the end. It's the same set of questions Clyvara asks in the first structured conversation with a new business. If more than one gives you pause, that's useful information: it tells you which phase to start with.

- [ ] MAPS TO SURVEY
  Walk through the technology your team uses day to day — email, file storage, industry software, payment processing. Could you name your actual attack surface, or would you be guessing?

- [ ] MAPS TO HARDEN
  Do you have a written cybersecurity policy — anything documented about passwords, data handling, or what to do if something goes wrong? Most businesses we talk to don't, and don't realize what that gap costs them until it matters.

- [ ] MAPS TO INSTRUCT
  When your team completes security training, do you know whether it changed anything they do — or only that the module was marked complete?

- [ ] MAPS TO ENFORCE
  If a team member clicked a phishing link tomorrow morning and your systems went down, what would happen? Who would you call first?

- [ ] MAPS TO LEDGER
  Do you have compliance requirements — HIPAA, PCI-DSS, cyber insurance, or client contracts that require security standards — and could you currently demonstrate you meet them, today, without a scramble?

HAVE YOU HAD A SECURITY INCIDENT ALREADY?

Even a small one — a phishing email someone almost clicked, or a password that got reused somewhere it shouldn't have been. A "no" here usually means no detection, not no incidents. That distinction alone is often the most useful thing a first conversation surfaces.

WHERE ORGANIZATIONS GET STUCK

The same four gaps, almost every time.

These aren't hypothetical failure modes. They're the patterns that show up most often once a business actually looks — across sector, size, and how long the business has been operating.

HARDEN

The policy exists somewhere. It just isn't used to make decisions.

Most businesses without a written policy know it. Fewer realize that a policy nobody references when a real decision comes up — a new vendor, a remote-work request, a data-sharing ask — isn't functioning as governance, even once it's written. A policy is a starting point, not a finish line.

INSTRUCT

Training gets completed. It doesn't always get absorbed.

A completed training module proves someone was informed. It doesn't prove they felt capable of acting on what they learned, or that acting on it felt worth the friction in the moment. Knowledge is a prerequisite for behavior change — not a guarantee of it. That gap is where training budgets quietly underperform.

ENFORCE

Nobody owns the moment something actually goes wrong.

Ask most business owners who they'd call first if their systems went down tomorrow morning, and the honest answer is silence. Not because the business is careless — because incident response was never assigned to a specific person, with a specific plan, practiced in advance. The plan a business hasn't tested isn't a plan yet.

LEDGER

The dashboard exists. Nobody opens it until renewal season.

Risk status that's only reviewed once a year — at a compliance deadline or an insurance renewal — is reviewed too late to change anything. The businesses that catch problems in weeks, not after a breach, are the ones that made the monthly review a habit rather than an annual scramble.

None of these four gaps is solved by buying more software. A training platform sells content; it doesn't build a programme around it. A policy template sells a document; it doesn't sell the discipline to use it. The platform needs a strategy to work — that strategy is what SHIELD is built to provide.

WHY CLYVARA

Depth a generalist can't offer. Access an enterprise firm won't give you.

Clyvara sits deliberately between the two extremes most small businesses are stuck choosing from: an overstretched IT generalist, or an enterprise firm priced for a Fortune 500 budget.

Research-Backed

The methodology behind every engagement is grounded in original doctoral research into why SMB cybersecurity programs actually fail — not a repackaged vendor checklist.

Focused

Clyvara doesn't sell IT support, digital transformation, or general consulting. Cybersecurity advisory is the entire practice — depth over breadth, always.

Accessible

Direct access to a credentialed principal consultant — not a junior analyst routed through account management layers at a larger firm.

Rodger Lutalo — Founder & Principal Cybersecurity Consultant

DBA

Doctorate in Business Administration

Original doctoral research examining cybersecurity awareness and training failures in small and mid-sized enterprises — the research foundation behind this entire methodology.

MS

MS, Computer Science

Graduate study spanning cybersecurity, networking, software engineering, cloud computing, information systems, and business analytics.

PMP

Project Management Professional

Every engagement scoped, managed, and delivered with defined milestones and documented outcomes — not open-ended hours.

Founder-led · Manager-managed LLC · Dallas–Fort Worth, Texas

START HERE

Book a free SHIELD Risk Conversation.

45 minutes, no obligation. We'll talk through where your business actually stands today — and whether Clyvara is the right fit, before anyone signs anything.

EMAIL
Info@clyvara.io

WEB
clyvara.io

LOCATION
Dallas–Fort Worth, TX

CLYVARA — CYBER RISK & COMPLIANCE ADVISORY · PROTECT WHAT YOU HAVE BUILT. ·
© 2026 CLYVARA LLC